FRENCH FOREIGN LEGIONNAIRE KIT

Few military formations in the world are as attached to their traditions as the French Foreign Legion. Thus an item of equipment like the white *képi*, of little practical relevance, remains of symbolic importance to its wearer. The Legion has always been armed with the best available French infantry weaponry; the MAS-49 was, at the time of France's Indochina War, a technologically advanced rifle. Reliable and accurate, it continued in service through the war in Algeria.

Képi blanc
The *képi blanc* became the official headgear of the French Foreign Legion in 1939. The original model had a removable white cover, seen here with a neck curtain attached, while today's variants are made of white plasticised cloth. A green beret is standard duty headwear for the Legion, with the *képi* worn on parade and off-duty.

Removable cover

False chin strap

Protective neck curtain

Desert scarf used as turban during sandstorms

M1947 fatigues
These light cotton desert fatigues were worn by legionnaires of the *Compagnie d'Instruction* in the Algerian war of 1954–62. They were designed for ease of movement in the North African heat.

Gas cylinder

Fore sight between protective blades

MAS-49 rifle
Developed in 1949 by *Manufacture d'Armes St. Etienne*, the MAS-49 is a semi-automatic infantry rifle which employs a direct impingement gas operating system. It is chambered for the 7.5x54 French round and takes a 10-round detachable magazine. It was first used by the Legion in the Indochina War of 1946–54.

Fore stock

Leather webbing

Barrel band